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Title:

Sports Atheist

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Sports Atheist

by

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Characters:

Joey: Our main character. A teen boy trying to convince his parents that there is life without Sports
Darren: Joey's dad. Strict believer in Sports
Marge: Joey's mom. Mid-western mom who thinks Sports are life
Coach: Joey's coach. Basically a Sports priest

Summary: In Joey's world, Sports is a religion, and Joey has had enough. When he tells his parents he doesn't believe in Sports anymore, it hits them hard, especially his dad. Joey tries to convince them that being a Sports Atheist just makes sense for him. Coach arrives and attempts a Sports exorcism, which is unsuccessful. Joey admits to his parents that he's thinking about participating in Speech, and when his dad discovers it's a competition, he's all in, so much so that Joey is left to wonder if he has just created a whole new set of problems for himself.

Dad: Jeez, where is that kid? I know he's awake. *(Directed offstage)* Joey! Get out here son! It's Sunday morning and you know what that means! Put on the new outfit your mom got you and let's get going! We don't want to be late and have everyone stare at us! Marge, see what you can do...

Mom: Yes, dear. Joey! Sweetie! JOEY! It's very important that we set a good example for the new neighbors, they're not from around here so we might be able to give them a little nudge in the right direction!

Joey: Hey Mom, hey Dad.

Mom: Oh, there he is! Joey. Joey, honey. Why aren't you wearing the jersey I bought you?

Dad: And where's your foam finger son? Are you sick? Do you have a concussion?

Joey: Mom, Dad, I'm fine, but I'm not going to Stadium with you.

Dad: What do you mean? Of course you're going! You were raised going to Stadium. Sure you could watch the game on TV, but it's not the same as being there with the other believers, all united as one, cheering and screaming at the refs. The hot dogs, the spilled beer, the plastic seats...The pee trough, Joey. The pee trough.

Joey: I don't know how to break this to you, and I wish there was a better way, but…Mom, Dad, I don't believe in Sports anymore.

Mom: Oh, Joey, no!

Dad: I think I'm gonna throw up...Oh yeah, I'm gonna throw up. *(Dry heaves a few times)* I can't. I haven't even had any lite beers *(or insert any brand here)* yet so I can't!

Mom: It'll come, Darren, it always does.

Dad: My own son, a Sports atheist. What's next? Oh, Favre, don't tell me you're a vegan, too?

INTRO: Do you have parents? Yeah they're great, but there comes a time in every child's life when they have to decide if they're going to believe everything that their parents believe. Joey has reached that point, but will he be able to convince his parents that there is life without sports? Sports Atheist, with music from the Fox NFL theme by Scott Shreer.

Joey: No, Dad, I'm not a vegan. If anything, I would start as an ovo-lacto vegetarian and then…

Dad: What in the name of Belichek *(or insert any current coach)* is going on here… We did everything right! You memorized the stats, we got you the trading cards, we made the pilgrimages to the Lambeaus, the Wrigleys, Madison Square Garden…

Mom: Our Vikings *(or insert NFL team here)*, which art in Minneapolis *(or insert city of team here)*, hallowed be their name. Thy Bowl shall come, it will be won. Indoors as it is outdoors. Give us this Sunday our weekly win. Give us our completed passes, but do not let others pass against us…

Dad: Marge, that's not going to work! Say a couple of Hail Maddens!

Mom: Oh… Hail Madden! Full of bratwurst… Blessed are you among all coaches and blessed are your Fruit of the Looms.

Dad: Joey, did some kids at school talk you into this? Was it those theater kids? I told you to stay away from those heathens!

Joey: No Dad, I just woke up one morning and thought, does this make any sense? Ever since I was three years old, I've been in at least three Sports a year. I've been getting up before dawn every day to go to practice. And we're on the road or at Stadium every weekend for tournaments…

Dad: Joey. Are you forgetting the dream? Those who follow the discipline of Sports have a great reward ahead of them! To the vision board! *(He runs to the vision board, obviously a prominent*

item in the house) The scholarships, the draft, the championships, the rings...and someday...if you are worthy...the Hall of Fame!

Joey: That's just it, Dad. I'm not good enough for that.

Mom: Oh, Joey, don't say that! You Sportsed so hard!

Joey: Mom, I know you tried. You wore out three SUVs just taking me to practice…

Mom: Well, honestly, honey, two of those were totaled ramming some filthy soccer moms off the road...

Dad: ...and for what? So you could throw this in our face? No, come on... Next week your team is going to win the city championship, and, well, we were keeping this a secret, but your mother and I have arranged for you to get your first Gatorade baptism!

Mom: The blue kind! Your favorite! Grandma and Grandpa are flying in…

Dad: And this'll break their hearts. Say you'll try.

Joey: What are the odds, Dad? Only 2% of athletes ever make a dime from their Sport, then only 1 out of a thousand of those players make it really big…

Dad: You think I don't know that? Salvation was just a touchdown away, but I failed…for all have fumbled and fallen short of the glory of the first down! Now, all I can do is to take those hopes and dreams and fears and failure and just sorta cram it all into you…*(sob)*…Marge, bring me a beer, I'm ready for throwing up now.

Mom: Darren, maybe we should talk to Coach. I already called. He's on his way.

Joey: Aw, man, don't drag Coach into this…

Dad: No, your mother's right. Coach will know what to do.

NFL Fox Theme DOORBELL

Marge: Oh, I love that doorbell!

Dad: Forgive me, Coach, it's been two weeks since my last coaching session… *(Makes sign of the cross, muttering "Helmet, Cup, Shoulder Pads.")*

Coach: *(Coach enters, carrying a smallish cooler, which he sets down as he speaks.)* Darren, if this is about Joey's playing time, I swear….

Mom: Coach, Joey doesn't believe in Sports anymore!

Coach: Are you sure he doesn't have a concussion? About half the team have concussions right now…

Dad: He seems fine.

Coach: Well, then, let me just try this. Joey… *(he grabs Joey and shakes him violently)* The Power of Sports compels you! The Power of Sports compels you!

Joey: What are you doing? Stop it! I'm not concussed and I'm not possessed, I just realized Sports are pointless.

Dad: Oh boy, here it comes… *(Dry heaves)*

Coach: Whoa, Darren, are you okay? Concussion, am I right?

Dad: No. Too much talkin', not enough drinkin and pukin'.

Coach: Huh. Okay Joey, I thought it might be something like this…*(He goes to his cooler)* Joey, you can drink this blue Gatorade and go back to your old life, or you can drink this red Gatorade and forget everything you ever knew about Sports. Or you can drink this grape juice and become a Baptist.

Joey: No thanks. What's in the Gatorade?

Coach: Nothing Joey, nothing but pure American electrolytes! Because even if you don't believe in Sports, you do still believe in hydration, don't you boy?

Joey: Oh, yes, sir!

Coach: And now…

(Coach starts a concussion test by holding out his finger and moving it in a triangle; it is reminiscent of a Catholic blessing.)

Joey: Are you blessing me or giving me the concussion eye test?

Coach: Oh boy. *(Coach focuses on his own finger in a confused manner)* I think I might have a concussion. But let's just keep that between the, uh…*(counts people in the room while moving his lips)* seven of us. *(There are four…)*

Joey: Sure, Coach.

Coach: Welp! You can't win 'em all, folks. Looks like you got yourself a Sports atheist here. *(Retrieves his cooler)* Coach Out!...Oh, and may the Sports be with you. *(Slams the door on the way out.)*

Mom: And also with you!

Dad: So, that's it? You're just gonna sit around after school and on the weekends and do nothing.

Joey: *(Goes to get his backpack and removes a flyer)* Actually, I was thinking about converting to Speech.

Mom: Converting? Spetch? Do you have to shave your head and wear a paper dress?

Joey: No. No. Nothing like that… It's public speaking, but it also has elements of humor and drama.

Dad: Did you get him vaccinated, Marge? I heard vaccinations can make your kid artistic.

Mom: Oh, honey, no…

Dad: Well then, he must have gotten it from your side of the family, because no one in my family is ever dramatic!

Mom: Sure Honey…. Oh, did you hear that the *(insert NFL team here) (released or traded) (insert NFL player)*?

Dad: *(Falling to his knees - a la Charlton Heston in Planet of the Apes)* No! Darn you! You maniacs! Darn you all to heck!

Joey: Well, um, we have practice after school, could you…

Dad: Practice? You mean there's a coach I can call or text day and night with random questions and suggestions?

Joey: Ummm, yeah…

Dad: Oooh! And how do we, I mean, how do YOU win?

Joey: Okay, there are judges…

Dad: Officials! When we disagree with them, can we berate and belittle them?

Joey: Yeah, but in Speech, they do it behind their backs.

Dad: Strange… but it's getting better.

Mom: Honey, do you need new shoes?

Joey: Yeah. Slippery ones.

(Joey and Dad quickly execute a series of character pops demonstrating foot movements that would benefit from slippery shoes.)

Dad: Slippery?

Joey: Slippery.

Dad: Slippery?

Joey: Slippery.

Dad: Seriously?

Joey: Seriously.

Dad: Why slippery?

Joey: No idea.

Dad: Alrighty then… So, when do you start?

Joey: I guess whenever I want…

Dad: Right now! You are gonna be the best…spetcher that there ever was! Top of the teeth, tip of the tongue!

Joey: What?

Dad: Say it! Louder, faster, crisper!

Joey: Top of the teeth, tip of the tongue!

Dad: That's the ticket! Marge, you go get him some shoes! Extra slippery! I'm gonna get him a suit…with a pocket square! Let's go!

Joey: Oh Favre, what have I done?

About the authors:
Micah Larson competed at the high school level for 6 years. For 5 of those years he was in Creative Expression. He wrote The Dire Disney Dilemma, Segregation of Students, The Fast Food Felony, The Worst Day Ever, and this script, Sports Atheist, with the help of Brian Sams, of course.

Brian Sams competed in high school Speech in the 80's, and has been a Speech coach since 1991. He is a business owner, part time actor, and a writer.

Awards:
A Minnesota State Champion script